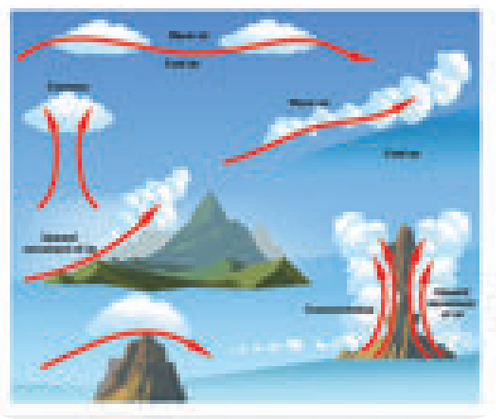
High clouds

Cirrus: Detached clouds in the form of white delicate fibrous silky filaments formed at the high sky (8000 meters to 12000 meters) are called Cirrus clouds. These clouds have Ice crystals and are dry and do not give rainfall.

Cirro-cumulus: White patched, sheet or layer like clouds composed of ice crystals.

Cirro-stratus: Smooth milky transparent whitish clouds composed of tiny ice crystals.



DO YOU KNOW?

During sunset cirrus clouds look colourful hence they are called as "Mare's Tails".

Middle clouds

Alto-stratus: Thin sheets of grey or blue coloured clouds in uniform appearance. consisting of frozen water droplets

Alto-cumulus: clouds fitted closely together in parallel bands, called as 'Sheep clouds' or wool pack clouds.

Nimbo stratus: These are clouds of dark colour very close to the ground surface associated with rain, snow or sleet.

DO YOU KNOW?

The only sphere which contains all clouds in the atmosphere is troposphere

Low clouds

Strato-cumulus:- Grey or whitish layer of non-fibrous low clouds found in rounded patches at an height of 2500 to 3000 metres, associated with fair or clear weather

Stratus:- Dense, low lying fog-like clouds associated with rain or snow

Cumulus:- Dome-shaped with a flat base often resembling a cauliflower, associated with fair weather

Cumulo-nimbus:- Fluffy thick towering thunderstorm cloud capable of producing heavy rain, snow, hailstorm or tornadoes

Precipitation

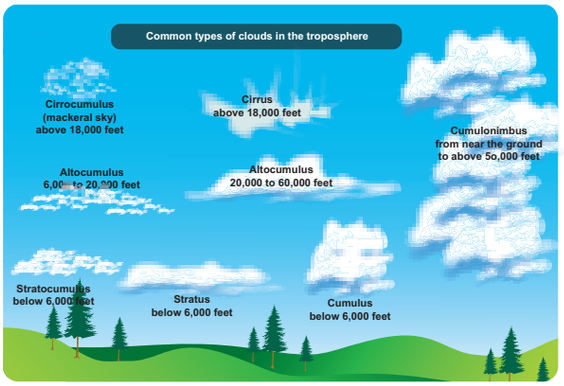
Falling down of condensed water vapour in different forms is called Precipitation. When the dew point is reached in the cloud water droplets become saturated and start to fall. Hence, they fall on the earth as Precipitation.

The climatic conditions/ factors influencing the forms of precipitation mainly are:

- Temperature.
- Altitude
- Cloud type.
- Atmospheric conditions.
- Precipitation process.

The main forms of precipitation include **drizzle, rain, sleet, snow, hail etc.**

Drizzle



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